DETACHMENT — HORUS HERESY (30K)

SMOKE AND MIRRORS

ALPHA LEGION (HH, TRAITOR) | WARHAMMER 40,000 | 11TH EDITION

Smoke and Mirrors is a fully homebrew Detachment for the Alpha Legion (XX Legion) faction — a Horus Heresy-era Traitor Legion detachment adapted to the Warhammer 40,000 11th-edition Detachment framework, built from the real HH3e Alpha Legion Rite of War data. Formatted to match the No Figure Left Behind Combat Patrol archive.

FACTION ABILITY

LIES AND OBFUSCATION
Nothing about their position is ever quite where it seems. Each time the range from an enemy model to a friendly Alpha Legion model is measured for the purposes of a ranged attack, a Charge move, or a Reaction, treat that range as being 2" greater than it actually is.

DETACHMENT RULE

Detachment Points: To use this detachment you must spend 1 DP.

SMOKE AND MIRRORS
Once per battle, when an enemy unit shoots a friendly Alpha Legion unit that includes an attached Character model, you can select that unit: until that attack is resolved, wounds from that attack must be allocated to non-Character models in that unit while any remain.

FORCE DISPOSITIONS
This detachment has access to the following Force Disposition: Disruption.

DETACHMENT COMPOSITION

Included: All homebrew Alpha Legion (HH) roster units (Alpharius, Armillus Dynat, Autilon Skorr, Effrit Disruption Cadre, Exodus, Headhunter Kill Team, Lernaean Terminator Squad, Saboteur, Inductii Squad), and any homebrew Legiones Astartes (HH) unit from the generic Space Marines (HH) roster given the Alpha Legion Trait.

Excluded: Any other Legion's Primarch or named characters. Non-Legiones-Astartes allies, per standard HH3e Legion-purity convention.

ENHANCEMENTS

MASK OF DECEPTION — *Character model only*
The bearer has a 5+ invulnerable save. If the bearer already has an invulnerable save, add 1 to its Invulnerable Save characteristic instead (to a maximum of a 3+ invulnerable save).

RELIC OF THE HYDRA — *Character model only*
Each time the bearer fights, that model's melee weapons have the [DEVASTATING WOUNDS] ability.

STANDARD OF THE COILED SERPENT — *Character model only*
While the bearer is leading a unit, each time a model in that unit is destroyed, roll one D6: on a 6, that model is not destroyed and instead is returned to the unit with 1 wound remaining.

UNKNOWN QUANTITY — *Character model only*
Each time the bearer's unit takes a Battle-shock test, that test is automatically passed.

STRATAGEMS

I AM ALPHARIUS **1CP**
Alpha Legion — Battle Tactic Stratagem
When: Fight phase, just before an enemy Character unit is chosen to fight.
Target: That unit.
Effect: That unit fights last in the Fight phase this turn, even if it has an ability that would let it fight first.

FORGE ANEW **1CP**
Alpha Legion — Strategic Ploy Stratagem
When: Your Command phase.
Target: One friendly Alpha Legion unit.
Effect: Until your next Command phase, that unit is not Battle-shocked while it is below its Starting Strength.

SEVER THE HEAD **1CP**
Alpha Legion — Epic Deed Stratagem
When: Fight phase, just after a friendly Alpha Legion unit destroys an enemy Character unit.
Target: Your army.
Effect: You gain 1 Command Point. This Stratagem can only be used once per battle.

MERCILESS RETALIATION **1CP**
Alpha Legion — Epic Deed Stratagem
When: Fight phase, just after a friendly Alpha Legion unit is destroyed.
Target: The enemy unit that destroyed it.
Effect: That enemy unit suffers 3 mortal wounds.

HYDRA'S BITE **2CP**
Alpha Legion — Battle Tactic Stratagem
When: Your Charge phase, just after a friendly Alpha Legion unit ends a Charge move.
Target: That unit.
Effect: Until the end of the turn, that unit's melee weapons have the [LETHAL HITS] ability.

SALVAGE THE FALLEN **2CP**
Alpha Legion — Battle Tactic Stratagem
When: Your Shooting phase, just after a friendly Alpha Legion Vehicle unit is selected to shoot.
Target: That unit.
Effect: Until the end of the phase, ranged weapons equipped by models in that unit have the [SUSTAINED HITS 1] ability.

DESIGNER'S NOTE

Homebrew — HH3e (2026) Alpha Legion Rite of War → 11e conversion. Built from the real HH3e Rite of War data in `Alpha Legion.json`, which has one baseline rite with three named pieces. Legion Tactica "Lies and Obfuscation" is real (Alpha Legion models are always treated as 2" further away than they are for ranged attacks, Charges, and Reactions) → Faction Ability, translated directly. Gambit "I Am Alpharius" (real: a Challenge-only ability that sets the opposing model's Combat Initiative to 1, forcing it to strike last) became the identically-named Stratagem, translated as a forced-fights-last effect that overrides Fights First, preserving the real "no matter how fast you think you are, you go last" spirit. Advanced Reaction "Smoke and Mirrors" (real: once per Shooting Attack against a pure-Alpha-Legion unit, Precision-type hits can only land on an unmodified 6+, denying the enemy the ability to snipe out an attached Character) was promoted to the Detachment Rule itself, matching how every other Legion's flagship real mechanic has anchored its own detachment — and a fitting flagship for a Legion whose entire doctrine is making sure the enemy never quite knows who they're really shooting at. Forge Anew, Sever the Head, Merciless Retaliation, Hydra's Bite, and Salvage the Fallen are original stratagems filling out the standard six; Enhancements are original, themed around the Legion's deceptive, unknowable, and coiled-serpent identity.